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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part IV

International cooperation for development

Section 10

Least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States

Programme 8

Least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 10)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 10)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 10.1 The Office of the High Representative for the Least Developed Countries, Landlocked Developing Countries and Small Island Developing States is responsible for advocating, undertaking research and analysis, mobilizing support and resources, coordinating and reporting on the implementation of the programmes of action for the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, as well as the achievement of other internationally agreed goals, including the Sustainable Development Goals. The mandate of the Office derives from the priorities established in relevant General Assembly resolutions and decisions, including resolution [56/227](#), whereby the Assembly decided to establish the Office of the High Representative for the Least Developed Countries, Landlocked Developing Countries and Small Island Developing States.
- 10.2 The work of the Office is grounded in the three programmes of action, namely, General Assembly resolution [76/258](#), whereby the Assembly endorsed the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the decade 2022–2031; resolution [78/317](#), whereby the Assembly endorsed the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity; and resolution [79/233](#), whereby the Assembly endorsed the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, including its global follow-up and review processes, is integral and complementary to the three programmes of action.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 10.3 Building on the national, regional and thematic preparatory process scheduled to be undertaken in 2026, the least developed countries and their development partners are expected to agree on a new global strategy at the comprehensive high-level midterm review, to be held in Qatar in 2027, to fully and efficiently implement the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries. In this context, the Office will support preparatory and follow-up processes, including by strengthening partnerships, supporting coordination among stakeholders and facilitating the mobilization of resources and knowledge to boost progress towards implementation of the 2030 Agenda, leave no one behind and contribute to accelerated implementation of the Doha Programme of Action, including its five deliverables, by the least developed countries and their development partners, through the mobilization of commensurate resources and knowledge in support of accelerating their sustainable development and enhanced monitoring and accountability.
- 10.4 In 2027, the central task ahead for the landlocked developing countries and their development partners is to strengthen partnerships to intensify efforts to operationalize the objectives and key deliverables of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries. In this regard, the Office will help with the mobilization of adequate financial, technical and capacity-building resources, undertake efforts to strengthen partnerships and support countries with integrating the Programme of Action into national development plans and relevant global frameworks, with a view to addressing the specific vulnerabilities of landlocked developing countries. These measures will contribute to accelerating progress towards implementation of the 2030 Agenda through structural transformation, resilience-building and sustainable development in the landlocked developing countries.
- 10.5 In 2027, small island developing States and their development partners will advance implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States, guided by its monitoring and evaluation framework to prioritize action and to track delivery and report results, and fully operationalize the small island developing States centre of excellence. The Office will actively advocate for the strengthening of global partnerships, including through the Small Island Developing

States Global Business Network, utilization of the multidimensional vulnerability index, enhanced access to concessional and climate financing, and strengthening the capacity of small island developing States' national focal points to integrate the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda into national development plans. In parallel, the Office will support the Small Island Developing States Partnership Framework to catalyse accountable results-driven partnerships and engage international financial institutions to drive financing that enable structural transformation and resilience-building. These efforts are intended to deliver early, tangible results under the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda that address the unique challenges and special needs of these States.

- 10.6 The Office will utilize its strategic position in directly supporting the three groups of countries to respond to current evolving development issues of potential concern, in particular those of a regional or global nature, such as climate change, food security and digital divides. In this regard, the newly established subprogramme 4, on advocacy, outreach and analysis, will enable a more coordinated implementation of the programmes of action, while improving the Office's capacity to produce analysis across regions and groups of countries, strengthen its research and data management capabilities and ensure more effective advocacy on shared development challenges.
- 10.7 The Office will continue to mobilize resources to ensure that the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States have their voices heard in global deliberations. Resource mobilization efforts will also have an increased focus on joint initiatives, which can amplify impact across the three groups of countries. Furthermore, representatives of the most vulnerable countries will benefit from capacity-building activities, peer learning and the exchange of best practices all on thematic areas relevant to the Sustainable Development Goals and to building resilience to future crises.
- 10.8 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, the Office will convene the inter-agency consultative groups for the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States. These groups will enable United Nations entities, funds and programmes and other international organizations to exchange information on their work, strengthen coordination of their activities and mount joint inter-agency activities. At the national level, the Office will cooperate with the networks of national focal points, which act as interfaces between global, regional and national processes. The national focal points will promote coherence and coordination on issues relevant to the three groups of countries and facilitate policy formulation, implementation, follow-up and review of their programmes of action, ensuring full alignment with the 2030 Agenda and other global frameworks.
- 10.9 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, the Office will work closely with resident coordinators to promote the integration of the programmes of action into the United Nations strategic plans and the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks and to act as an interface with Member States on the ground supporting the mainstreaming of the programmes of action into national strategies.
- 10.10 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
 - (a) The security and political situation in the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States and in their surrounding regions is conducive to the implementation of the three programmes of action;
 - (b) Continued international support measures in the areas of development finance, market access, technology and technical assistance are made available by development partners.
- 10.11 The Office will further explore the ways of cooperation, support and participation in the global efforts towards the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and the Pact of the Future, with special attention given to the needs of those in vulnerable situations, women, young people, persons with disabilities and older persons.
- 10.12 The Office integrates a gender perspective into its operational activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate. The Office will implement its gender equality strategy for the period 2025–2029 and

mainstream a gender perspective into its programme of work. In addition, as part of its monitoring and reporting work, the Office will include sex-disaggregated data and analysis across its reports for the three groups of countries.

- 10.13 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, the Office will focus on strengthening knowledge management, learning and capacity for promoting disability inclusion in all aspects of the Office's work programme, including monitoring, reporting and advocacy activities, in accordance with its mandate. For example, the Office will continue to advocate for the inclusion of language and references to disability inclusion in intergovernmental deliberations, as appropriate and in accordance with its mandates.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 10.14 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated planned deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026.
- 10.15 The Office will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions concerning proposals aimed at streamlining support for the three groups of countries and strengthening and optimizing organizational arrangements in this regard, as appropriate.

Legislative mandates

- 10.16 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

56/227	Third United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries	79/226	Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	79/1	The Pact for the Future
78/322; 80/146	Multidimensional Vulnerability Index		

Subprogramme 1 Least developed countries

General Assembly resolutions

76/258	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries	80/150	Follow-up to the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries
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Economic and Social Council resolutions

2025/23	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the decade 2022–2031
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Subprogramme 2 Landlocked developing countries

General Assembly resolutions

79/233	Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034	80/151	Follow up to the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries
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79/279 Further modalities of the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries 80/3 Awaza Political Declaration

Subprogramme 3 Small island developing States

General Assembly resolutions

78/317 The Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity 80/136 Follow-up to and implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity

Deliverables

10.17 Table 10.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 10.1

Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	4	5	4
Meetings of:				
1. The groups of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	1	1	2	1
2. The Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
3. The Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
4. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Publications (number of publications)	5	1	–	–
5. Thematic reports of the Office on challenges facing the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, including shared challenges such as vulnerabilities to external shocks, access to sustainable energy and access to broadband services ^a	5	1	–	–

^a Beginning with the proposed programme budget for 2026, this deliverable is presented under subprogramme 4, Advocacy, outreach and analysis.

Evaluation activities

- 10.18 An evaluation conducted by the Office on the effectiveness of the support to the network of national focal points of the small islands development States, completed in 2025, has guided the proposed programme plan for 2027.
- 10.19 In response to the results of the evaluation referenced above, subprogramme 3 will further refine the programme design of meetings of national focal points to make the meetings more participant-driven, reducing the reliance on panel-only formats and expanding hands-on working sessions, breakout discussions and peer exchange. Practical exercises using the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States monitoring and evaluation framework and the national focal point toolkit will be embedded to strengthen immediate uptake, followed by short virtual clinics and concise guidance products to help national focal points to apply the tools confidently in their national contexts.

- 10.20 An evaluation of support for countries graduating from the least developed country category is planned for 2027.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1 Least developed countries

Objective

- 10.21 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to eradicate poverty in the least developed countries and accelerate structural transformation of their economies, and to ensure effective graduation from the least developed country category.

Strategy

- 10.22 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide support to Member States in their intergovernmental processes relating to the priorities of the least developed countries, including by supporting the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries, including its deliverables, namely, an online university to support graduate and postgraduate university-level education in science, technology, engineering and mathematics, an investment support centre, a resilience-building mechanism, a Sustainable Graduation Support Facility and a system of food stockholding for the least developed countries on a regional and subregional basis, or alternative means, such as cash transfers, taking into account possible economic implications and risks;
 - (b) Prepare research and analytical materials relating to the six key focus areas of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries and facilitate knowledge exchange and peer learning on critical enablers to poverty eradication and structural transformation, including by mainstreaming a gender perspective;
 - (c) Promote resource mobilization, especially public and private financing, including innovative finance, for resilience-building, and monitor the road map for the accelerated implementation of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries, in partnership with the United Nations system, parliaments, civil society, the private sector, the media, academia and foundations in focus areas of the Doha Programme of Action, in preparation for the comprehensive high-level midterm review of the Doha Programme of Action;
 - (d) Lead the inter-agency task forces on: (i) least developed country graduation, including by organizing workshops and technical support on establishing consultative mechanisms with development partners and preparing smooth transition strategies, and by facilitating peer learning between graduated and graduating countries; and (ii) developing operational guidelines for the United Nations system's support for least developed countries in conflict and post-conflict situations;
 - (e) Monitor sectoral policy developments of the intergovernmental processes of relevant international and regional organizations, including multilateral development banks;
 - (f) Build the capacity of national focal points to implement and monitor the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries, through annual meetings and training programmes, to share experiences and best practices, including through the application of guidelines for mainstreaming and monitoring the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action, and with a more structured collaboration with resident coordinators, in preparation for the comprehensive high-level midterm review of the Doha Programme of Action;

- (g) Partner with the Technology Bank for the Least Developed Countries to strengthen science, technology and innovation capacity, including in graduated and graduating countries.

10.23 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Least developed countries accelerating progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and achieving the focus areas of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries and other internationally agreed development goals;
- (b) Graduating countries making a smooth transition out of the least developed country category;
- (c) Stronger alignment of intergovernmental discussions with the priorities of least developed countries, reflecting a deeper understanding of their realities;
- (d) Greater accountability of least developed countries, development partners, international organizations, civil society and the private sector in the implementation of the commitments of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries.

Programme performance in 2025

Accelerated implementation and strengthened monitoring of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries

10.24 Least developed countries continue to face overlapping crises and structural vulnerabilities, underscoring the need for accelerated and better-sequenced implementation of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries and its milestones towards 2031. The subprogramme responded by developing and promoting the road map for the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action, launched in 2024, and its associated monitoring framework finalized in 2025 and developed with the Inter-Agency Consultative Group for Least Developed Countries and national focal points. In 2025, the subprogramme further supported the use of these tools through targeted outreach and training to least developed countries, guidance on integration into national development plans and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks, the facilitation of exchanges among national focal points, United Nations country teams and other stakeholders on alignment with midterm milestones and review, and a training workshop for African least developed countries on the monitoring framework and its integration into national review reports of the Doha Programme of Action.

10.25 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.2).

Table 10.2

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	28 least developed countries improved their national monitoring and evaluation systems using the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries road map and monitoring framework as reference tools for integrating priorities and monitoring progress

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: a new food stockholding mechanism to reduce food insecurity in least developed countries

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.26 The subprogramme's work contributed to the establishment of a task force to guide the preparation of a comprehensive feasibility study for the operationalization of the Food Stockholding Mechanism for the Least Developed Countries, which did not meet the planned target of agreement by Member States to establish a food stockholding system for the least developed countries. The target was not met because the comprehensive feasibility study that will inform Member State deliberations has not concluded.
- 10.27 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.3).

Table 10.3

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Member States at the United Nations Food Systems Summit +2 Stocktaking Moment highlighted the urgency of establishing a food stockholding system for the least developed countries	Member States provided input to the conceptualization of a food stockholding system for the least developed countries	Establishment of a task force to guide the preparation of a comprehensive feasibility study for the operationalization of the Food Stockholding Mechanism for the Least Developed Countries	Initial phase of operation of a food stockholding system is operationalized	Member States consider a road map for the operationalization of the Food Stockholding Mechanism for the Least Developed Countries and plans for a pilot scheme for a limited group of least developed countries

Result 2: strengthened resilience to external shocks in the least developed countries

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.28 The subprogramme's work contributed to 13 least developed countries building national and community response capabilities to increase multi-hazard resilience to external shocks, which exceeded the planned target of 10.
- 10.29 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.4).

Table 10.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Member States consider policy recommendations in the report on the status of multi-hazard early warning systems in the least developed countries, which identified critical areas for engagement to support the least developed countries	Thirteen least developed countries build national and community response capabilities to increase multi-hazard resilience to external shocks	A further five least developed countries build national and community response capabilities to increase multi-hazard resilience to external shocks	An additional five least developed countries build national and community response capabilities to increase multi-hazard resilience to external shocks

Result 3: least developing countries strengthen pathways for sustainable and irreversible graduation from the least developed country category

Proposed programme plan for 2027

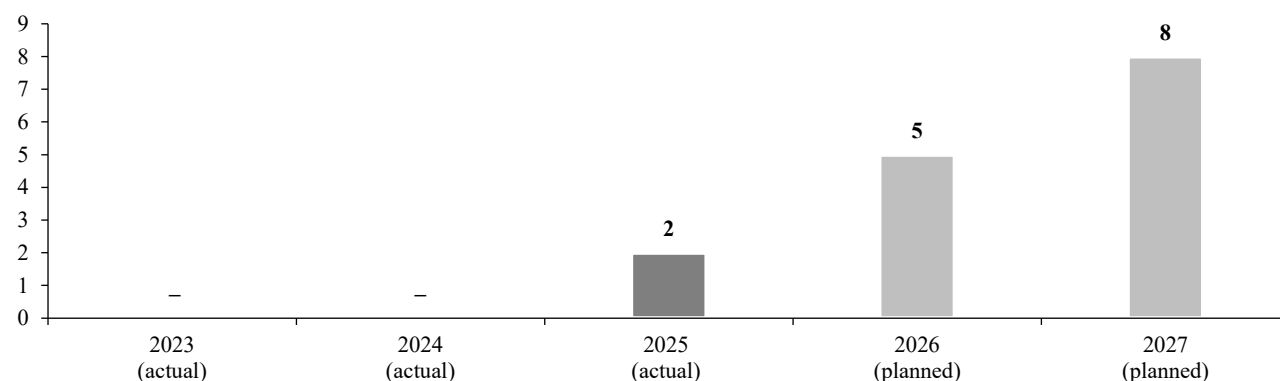
- 10.30 As more least developed countries meet the graduation thresholds, the General Assembly has underlined that graduation must not lead to setbacks in sustainable development. The subprogramme has operationalized the Sustainable Graduation Support Facility to respond to growing country requests for tailored support in the design and implementation of incentive-based smooth transition strategies.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 10.31 The lesson for the subprogramme was that support for least developed countries too often prioritized meeting statistical thresholds over building resilient postgraduation trajectories grounded in vulnerability-responsive international support measures and nationally owned transition strategies. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will place a greater emphasis on: (a) country-tailored diagnostics of graduation readiness; (b) systematic use of the Sustainable Graduation Support Facility as a platform for integrated, cross-pillar support; and (c) structured engagement with providers of international support measures to promote incentives-based, time-bound and predictable transition arrangements that reduce the risk of reversal and make graduation a springboard for sustained implementation of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries.
- 10.32 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 10.I).

Figure 10.I

Performance measure: number of least developed countries using the Sustainable Graduation Support Facility to undertake assessments and develop strategies, plans and policies for sustainable and irreversible graduation (cumulative)



Deliverables

10.33 Table 10.5 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 10.5

Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	1	1
1. Reports to the General Assembly and the Economic and Social Council, including on the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries	2	2	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	46	41	48	56
2. Meetings of the General Assembly	13	13	13	13
3. Meetings of the Economic and Social Council, including on the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action, and the high-level political forum on sustainable development	10	10	10	10
4. Regional review meetings on the Doha Programme of Action	–	–	2	–
5. Meetings of the midterm review of the Doha Programme of Action	–	–	–	10
6. Ministerial meetings of the least developed countries and related consultations	7	7	7	7
7. Meetings of ad hoc expert groups on the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action and related priority topics thereof	6	7	6	6
8. Meetings of the Group of Least Developed Countries, including meetings of its Bureau	10	4	10	10
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	17	17	18	18
9. Workshops for national focal points of the least developed countries and round-table discussions on the implementation and monitoring of the Doha Programme of Action	10	10	10	10
10. Seminars on partnerships for the least developed countries to strengthen the engagement of stakeholders	4	4	4	4
11. Workshops for government officials and other practitioners on the establishment of the main deliverables of the Doha Programme of Action	2	2	2	2
12. Least Developed Countries Future Forum to strengthen dialogue between researchers and policymakers	1	1	2	2

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
Publications (number of publications)	2	–	1	1
13. On the state of the least developed countries	1	–	1	1
14. On the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action and synergies with the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development	1	–	–	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	15	7	15	15
15. On progress towards the graduation of the least developed countries	1	1	1	1
16. On the implementation of specific areas of the Doha Programme of Action, including preparation of the comprehensive high-level midterm review of the Doha Programme of Action	5	2	5	5
17. On issues relating to the least developed countries	8	3	8	8
18. Report on the implementation of the road map for accelerated implementation of the Doha Programme of Action including its monitoring	1	1	1	1

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: substantive advice to the Group of Least Developed Countries on the implementation of the Doha Programme of Action; briefing to Member States on the work of the Office and the Technology Bank for the Least Developed Countries; advice and substantive support to the work of the Broadband Commission; advocacy for improved international support measures catered to the least developed countries; and consultation through the Inter-Agency Consultative Group for Least Developed Countries to mobilize enhanced support for least development countries, including enhanced smooth transition measures for least developed countries and participation in high-level meetings.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: events to raise awareness on priority issues, thematic agendas relevant to the least developed countries and communications campaigns on upcoming graduations of the least developed countries, the Least Developed Countries Future Forum and ministerial meetings.

Subprogramme 2 Landlocked developing countries

Objective

- 10.34 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance sustainable and resilient development in landlocked developing countries characterized by structural transformation and growth of science, technology and innovation, by increased trade, trade facilitation and regional integration, by improved transit, transport and connectivity, and by enhanced adaptive capacity, strengthening resilience and reducing vulnerability to climate change and disasters

Strategy

- 10.35 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide support to Member States in their intergovernmental processes relating to the priorities of landlocked developing countries, including by supporting the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries;
 - (b) Undertake research and analytical assessments to assist landlocked developing countries in enacting policies conducive to their developmental priorities in line of those contained in the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries;
 - (c) Mobilize international support for the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries and other relevant agendas;

- (d) Coordinate, monitor and assess progress made in relation to the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries, including through the Inter-Agency Consultative Group for Landlocked Developing Countries;
- (e) Build the capacity of the national focal points of landlocked developing countries, in collaboration with the resident coordinators, to facilitate the mainstreaming of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries into their national development plans.

10.36 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Increased support towards landlocked developing countries from the international community to address the needs and challenges arising from their lack of direct access to the sea and transit constraints;
- (b) Increased adoption and implementation by landlocked developing countries of initiatives to enhance transit, connectivity, trade facilitation and climate change adaptation and mitigation;
- (c) Landlocked developing countries devising, formulating and implementing policies that promote economic diversification, integration into global and regional value chains, and structural economic transformation;
- (d) Strengthened social protection for all groups of population in landlocked developing countries, including through access to decent jobs.

Programme performance in 2025

Adoption of the Awaza Political Declaration at the third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries

10.37 Mobilization of global support and collective commitment can help to strengthen international solidarity to address the specific needs and challenges faced by landlocked developing countries such as the lack of direct territorial access to the sea, obstacles to transport and communication and long distances from major markets. The Office played a central role in supporting the preparation, organization and successful outcome of the third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries. In its capacity as the United Nations system-wide coordinator and advocate for landlocked developing countries, the Office provided substantive, technical and organizational support throughout the intergovernmental preparatory process, including the facilitation of consultations among Member States and stakeholders on the content of the Awaza Political Declaration. The Office supported the development of background documentation, analytical input and draft outcome elements, ensuring that the Political Declaration was informed by evidence, reflected emerging global challenges and responded to the priorities articulated by landlocked developing countries. It also worked closely with the host country, relevant United Nations entities, regional commissions and development partners to ensure inclusive participation and broad ownership of the Conference outcomes.

10.38 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.6).

Table 10.6
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Member States declared their resolve to act urgently and collectively to deliver the commitments made in the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries through the adoption of the Awaza Political Declaration at the third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: strategic financing for development initiatives to enhance landlocked developing countries' economic resilience

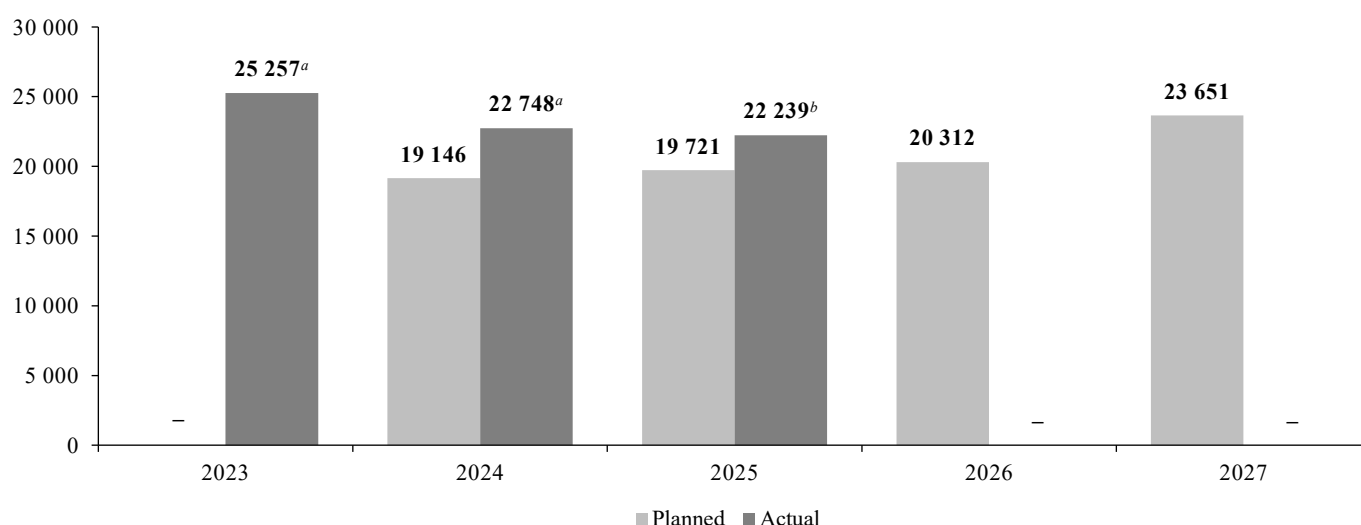
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.39 The subprogramme's work contributed to \$22,239 million in foreign direct investment flows to landlocked developing countries and strengthened engagement of landlocked developing countries with strategic financing for development initiatives to enhance economic resilience, which exceeded the planned target of \$19,721 million.
- 10.40 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 10.II).

Figure 10.II

Performance measure: foreign direct investment inflows to landlocked developing countries (annual)

(Millions of United States dollars)



^a Revised based on updated foreign direct investment inflows to landlocked developing countries as reported in UNCTADstat.

^b Based on the application of estimates for developing countries for 2025 from the Global Investment Trends Monitor No.50, January 2026.

Result 2: advancement of freedom of transit issues for landlocked developing countries**Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 10.41 The subprogramme's work contributed to the establishment of a task force of relevant United Nations entities to provide technical and institutional support to a high-level panel of experts, which did not meet the planned target of a high-level panel of experts to examine the application of existing international laws and agreements, identify constraints and make recommendations on the freedom of transit for landlocked developing countries. The target was not met because a high-level panel of experts has not yet been formally constituted.
- 10.42 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.7).

Table 10.7

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
–	Member States agree to establish a high-level panel of experts to examine the application of existing international laws and agreements, identify constraints and make recommendations on the freedom of transit for landlocked developing countries	Establishment of a task force of relevant United Nations entities to provide technical and institutional support to a high-level panel of experts	Member States consider the high-level panel of experts report and its recommendations with a view to developing a road map on issues of freedom of transit for landlocked developing countries	Member States consider options to support the implementation of the recommendations of the high-level panel of experts

Result 3: mainstreaming of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries into national and sectoral development strategies, development cooperation frameworks and strategic plans**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 10.43 Mainstreaming the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries into national and sectoral development strategies, development cooperation frameworks and strategic plans supports its effective implementation by helping to ensure that the national priorities of landlocked developing countries are reflected in policy dialogue, monitoring frameworks and coordinated development support. The subprogramme contributed to advancing the mainstreaming of the Awaza Programme of Action through national-level workshops in selected landlocked developing countries, participation in regional meetings on monitoring and follow-up, and engagement with United Nations coordination mechanisms.

Lessons learned and planned change

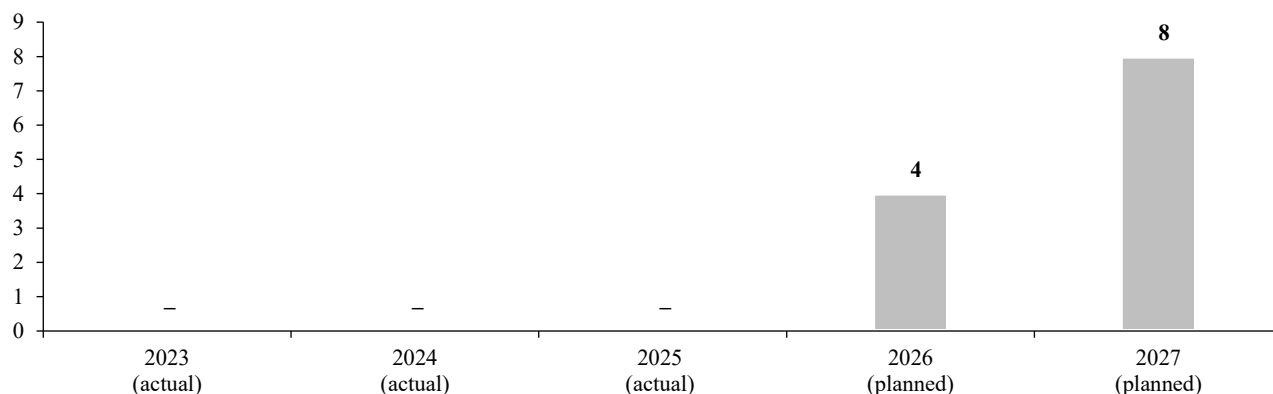
- 10.44 The lesson for the subprogramme was that targeted, sustained country-level engagement was particularly effective in advancing the implementation and the mainstreaming of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries into national development planning and monitoring processes. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will increase its focus on sustained country-level engagement complemented by regional-level outreach. Delivery modalities will increasingly combine focused in-country support with virtual engagement to improve reach and cost-effectiveness. The subprogramme will also shift from broad awareness-raising towards more

practical, implementation-oriented guidance linked to planning and monitoring processes, and strengthen the use of standardized and automated tools to support follow-up and reporting.

10.45 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 10.III).

Figure 10.III

Performance measure: number of countries mainstreaming the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries into national development planning and monitoring processes (cumulative)



Deliverables

10.46 Table 10.8 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 10.8

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	2	1
1. Reports to the General Assembly on the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries	1	1	2	1
2. Awaza Political Declaration (General Assembly resolution 80/3)	–	1	–	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	36	27	35	35
3. Meetings of the Second Committee of the General Assembly	13	9	13	13
4. Meetings of the high-level political forum on sustainable development of the Economic and Social Council	2	2	2	2
5. Annual ministerial meetings of the landlocked developing countries and consultations on outcomes thereof, and other ministerial meetings	8	8	8	8
6. Regional review meetings on the Awaza Programme of Action	3	–	–	–
7. Meetings of the Group of Landlocked Developing Countries	8	5	8	8
8. Expert group meetings on thematic issues such as structural economic transformation, digitalization, financing for development, trade facilitation measures and climate-resilient transport systems	2	2	4 [2]	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	7	5	5
9. On the enhancement of the analytical capacity of the International Think Tank for Landlocked Developing Countries	1	4	1	1
10. On the enhancement of the role of the private sector in trade facilitation and structural transformation	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
11. On strengthening of the participation of landlocked developing countries in relevant regional and bilateral cooperation frameworks and their accession to international conventions, and corridor development	1	1	1	1
12. On coordination of the enhanced implementation of the road map for accelerated implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action	–	–	1	1
13. On estimating transport and trade costs and designing and implementing policies that promote connectivity and enhanced utilization of digital solutions for transport and trade facilitation for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	7	10	7	7
14. Round-table discussion on capacity-building	1	5	1	1
15. Workshop for national focal points of landlocked developing countries	1	1	1	1
16. Panel discussion on best practices and solutions to specific needs of landlocked developing countries	1	1	1	1
17. Training events covering energy, information and communications technology, infrastructure, Sustainable Development Goal 14, climate change and desertification	2	2	2	2
18. Workshops on mainstreaming the programme of action for landlocked developing countries for the decade 2024–2034 and developing the road map and monitoring framework	2	1	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	4	3	4	3
19. On monitoring the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action and the 2030 Agenda	1	1	1	1
20. On thematic development issues in landlocked developing countries	2	2	2 [1]	2
21. Guide on mainstreaming the Awaza Programme of Action	1	–	1	–
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to the Group of Landlocked Developing Countries; and briefings to 32 landlocked developing countries, 34 transit countries and 28 development partners on the work of the Office.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: events to raise awareness on priority issues, thematic agendas relevant to landlocked developing countries.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 10).

Subprogramme 3 Small island developing States

Objective

- 10.47 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance sustainable development and economic, social and environmental resilience in small island developing States.

Strategy

- 10.48 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Mobilize support for the special case of small island developing States in achieving sustainable development by engaging with development partners, international financial institutions and the private sector;
 - (b) Support resource mobilization efforts for small island developing States in priority areas, including through a targeted resource mobilization strategy and by developing tailored policy tools;

- (c) Provide structured support through the Small Island Developing States Partnership Framework for the facilitation of collaborative partnerships, especially between small island developing States and the private sector;
- (d) Strengthen coherence and coordination at the national, regional and global levels, including by providing more structured support to the small island developing States national focal points network and increasing coordination between United Nations entities supporting those States;
- (e) Develop and strengthen the implementation frameworks for the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States.

10.49 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Strengthened international support measures aimed at enabling small island developing States to implement the 2030 Agenda, the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States, the Paris Agreement and other priorities of those States for sustainable development;
- (b) Enhanced access to finance for small island developing States;
- (c) Small island developing States formulating and implementing policies that promote sustainable development and make progress towards the achievement of internationally agreed development goals.

Programme performance in 2025

Advancing debt sustainability for small island developing States

10.50 Small island developing States often face external debt and public debt sustainability challenges owing in part to their vulnerabilities to the ongoing negative impacts of multiple crises, in particular environmental challenges and external economic and financial shocks. In 2025, the Office played a catalytic role in advancing the operationalization of the Small Island Developing States Debt Sustainability Support Service – a comprehensive framework designed to assist small island developing States in strengthening debt analysis, expanding policy options, facilitating debt restructuring and fostering resilient financing pathways – by facilitating intergovernmental consultations, supporting the development of its governance and operational modalities and fostering partnerships with relevant United Nations entities, regional development banks and international stakeholders. These efforts contributed to the development of a concept paper, co-designed in collaboration with small island developing State leaders and industry representatives.

10.51 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.9).

Table 10.9

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	–	Strategic advisory group considers a concept paper for the operationalization of the Small Island Developing States Debt Sustainability Support Service to improve debt sustainability for small island developing States

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: data-driven decisions to address structural vulnerabilities and resilience of small island developing States

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.52 The subprogramme's work contributed to the operationalization of the centre of excellence, which culminated in its high-level opening and the development of its implementation road map, which did not meet the planned target of the small island developing States global data hub providing analytics and data that Member States may use to inform decision-making processes related to sustainable development and climate change, among others, on the basis of their development priorities. The target was not met because there were ongoing consultations to finalize governance arrangements and institutional modalities.
- 10.53 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.10).

Table 10.10

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Government of Antigua and Barbuda decides to establish a centre of excellence that will include the small island developing States global data hub	The fourth International Conference on Small Island Developing States launched the centre of excellence	Operationalization of the centre of excellence, which culminated in its high-level opening and the development of its implementation road map	The small island developing States global data hub contributes to the improved availability, accessibility and utilization of data, including geospatial information, and knowledge resources to inform decision-making processes	The small island developing States global data hub contributes to strengthened technical capacity of country data hubs to exploit new data sources, enabling technologies and information systems, to enhance national sustainable development frameworks, strategies and policies

Result 2: small island developing States use the monitoring and reporting framework for the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States to inform national planning strategies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.54 The subprogramme's work contributed to Member States' endorsement of the monitoring and evaluation reporting framework for the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States, which met the planned target.
- 10.55 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.11).

Table 10.11
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	The General Assembly adopted the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	Member States endorse the monitoring and evaluation reporting framework for the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	Small island developing States use the agreed monitoring and evaluation framework to inform national planning strategies	Small island developing States produce national reports using the monitoring and evaluation framework

Result 3: unlocking strategic partnerships to accelerate implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 10.56 To help to foster strategic partnerships for the sustainable development of small island developing States, the subprogramme established the Small Island Developing States Global Business Network, which provides a platform and resource hub for the facilitation of partnerships, with special attention given to private sector partnerships.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 10.57 The lesson for the subprogramme was that small island developing States would benefit from better data, which could inform business and investment decisions. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will provide practical support to small island developing States and relevant stakeholders to use the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States monitoring and evaluation framework to strengthen data availability and analysis, with a view to identifying potential areas for bankable projects.
- 10.58 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 10.12).

Table 10.12
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	–	Private sector partnerships to advance implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States are launched at the Small Island Developing States Global Business Network Forum	Operationalization of private sector partnerships, including bankable projects, to advance implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States

Deliverables

10.59 Table 10.13 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 10.13

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^b	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	15	14	14	14
1. Meetings of the Second Committee of the General Assembly	3	5	3	4
2. Meetings and consultations of the high-level political forum on sustainable development of the Economic and Social Council	3	3	3	2
3. Review meetings on the implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	—	—	2	2
4. Meetings of the group of small island developing States	6	3	3	3
5. Expert group meetings on mainstreaming the small island developing States programme of action and issues relating to small island developing States in the work of the United Nations system and enhancing the coherence of issues relating to small island developing States in United Nations processes	3	3	3	3
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	—	1	1
6. On strengthening the capacity of small island developing States to attract climate finance from the private sector	1	—	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	16	15	18	16
7. Seminars on the support from development partners and the Alliance of Small Island States to small island developing States relating to the implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and the 2030 Agenda ^a	6	6	7 [6]	6
8. Seminars with national focal points on the coordination of efforts to achieve and monitor the implementation of Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and the 2030 Agenda	2	1	2	2
9. Seminars on strengthening collaboration through joint efforts and activities in the United Nations system and other international organizations, including regional intergovernmental organizations of which the small island developing States are members	3	2	3	3
10. Seminars on private sector involvement in supporting implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	4	5	4 [3]	3
11. Seminars on the access of small island developing States to climate change-related finance for development goals	1	1	2	2
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1	1
12. On mainstreaming the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and related issues into the work of the United Nations system and enhancing the coherence of issues relating to small island developing States in United Nations processes	1	1	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	10	3	11	8
13. On implementing the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and the 2030 Agenda	4	1	4	4
14. On international support provided to small island developing States for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States	2	—	2	1
15. On matters relating to the financing, implementation and monitoring of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and the 2030 Agenda	2	1	3 [2]	2
16. On mainstreaming the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States and related issues into the work of the United Nations system and enhancing the coherence of issues relating to small island developing States in United Nations processes	2	1	2	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^b	2027 planned
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C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: briefings to 37 Member States on the work of the Office; and advocacy in appropriate forums for the special case of small island developing States in achieving sustainable development.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: events to raise awareness on priority issues and thematic agendas relevant to 37 small island developing States.

^a Presented in A/80/6 (Sect. 10) as “7. Seminars on the support from development partners to small island developing States for the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and the implementation of the small island developing States programme of action” and “8. Seminars in support of the Alliance of Small Island States to small island developing States relating to the implementation of the small island developing States programme of action and the 2030 Agenda”.

^b Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 10).

Subprogramme 4 Advocacy, outreach and analysis

Objective

- 10.60 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance the sustainable development priorities and the shared challenges of the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States.

Strategy

- 10.61 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Generate data analysis and insights and publish analytical research for the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, including cross-cutting flagship reports, analytical briefs and trend analysis, on topics that align with and support the advancement of three programmes of action and global development agendas;
 - (b) Provide, in preparing for intergovernmental processes, substantive support on the regional and country specificities of research and trend analysis for ongoing and emerging issues affecting the three groups of countries;
 - (c) Build research partnerships and networks, in particular in emerging areas and for enhanced data collection and analysis among and within the three groups of countries;
 - (d) Develop outreach campaigns, using data-driven storytelling and multimedia products, on the specific challenges and opportunities of the three groups of countries and the priorities of the three programmes of action;
 - (e) Advocate for sustained and adequate international support for the three programmes of action and the integration of these priorities into global agendas by organizing high-level events, convening multi-stakeholder dialogues and engaging in targeted advocacy with decision makers in intergovernmental forums.
- 10.62 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Strengthened implementation of evidence-based policies and decision-making by the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States;
 - (b) Increased understanding and engagement of target audiences, in particular decision makers, in support of and for the advancement of the priorities of the three programmes of action.

Planned result for 2027

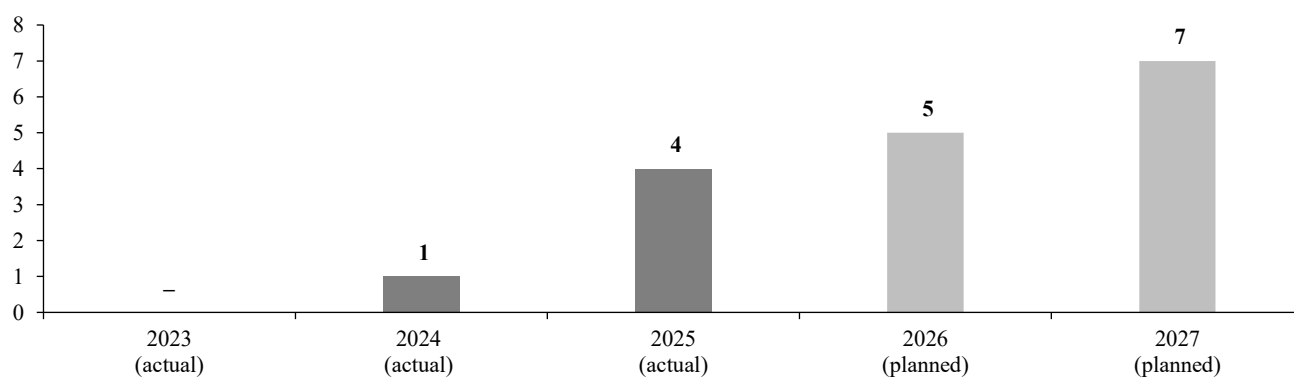
Result 1: strengthened integration of the three programmes of action into relevant intergovernmental processes

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 10.63 The subprogramme's work contributed to four countries, Angola, the Gambia, Saint Lucia and Seychelles, integrating their programmes of action into their voluntary national reviews, which exceeded the planned target of two.
- 10.64 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 10.IV).

Figure 10.IV

Performance measure: number of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States integrating their programmes of action into the voluntary national reviews (cumulative)



Result 2: real-time analytics and monitoring of the three programmes of action to inform policy formulation, planning and decision-making

Proposed programme plan for 2027

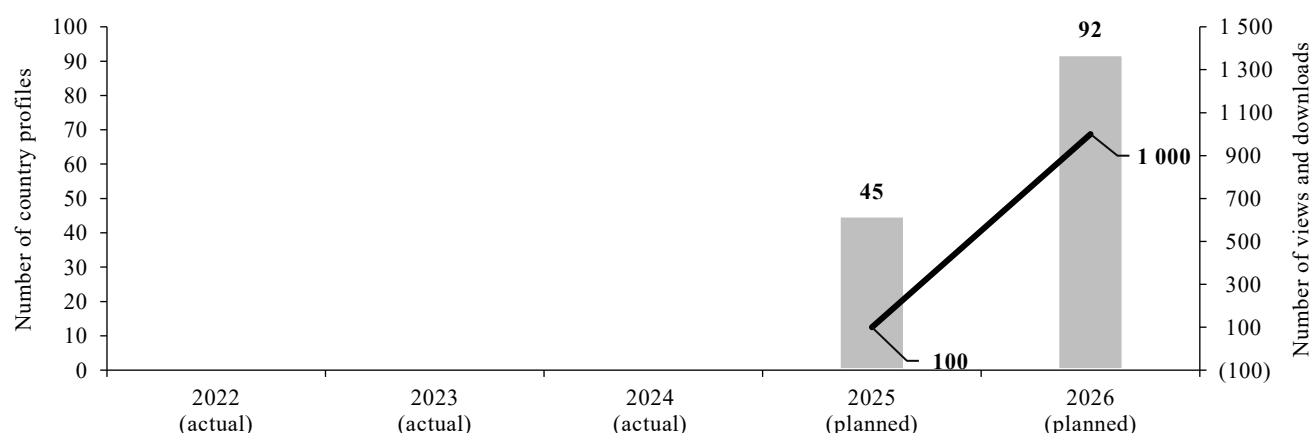
- 10.65 Recognizing data as a critical asset to help to inform and deliver better outcomes, the Office has been developing a data platform to serve as a central hub for real-time, high-quality country-level data. The data platform, which is expected to launch during 2026, is being built to support real-time analytics and visualization tools for the monitoring of the three programmes of action with complementary data, including development-related indicators across multiple thematic areas.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 10.66 The lesson for the subprogramme was that there were significant opportunities to reduce the reporting burden of Member States and strengthen the robustness of analysis of monitoring progress of the three programmes of action through the mapping and use of existing global monitoring frameworks. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will map global monitoring frameworks, including the targets of the Sustainable Development Goals, to identify a set of indicators suitable for regular monitoring and reporting. On the basis of these findings, the Office will select a set of indicators based on methodological robustness, data availability, comparability and accessibility through custodian agency platforms. For example, the Office's analysis has shown that more than 60 per cent of targets of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Development Countries are either identical or aligned closely with the targets of the Goals, allowing for the use of existing indicators.
- 10.67 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 10.V).

Figure 10.V

Performance measure: number of country profiles with up-to-date, accessible data and number of views and downloads of data, data visualizations, dashboards or analytics from the data platform (annual)



Deliverables

10.68 Table 10.14 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 10.14

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	–	–	2	2
1. Meetings of the groups of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	–	–	2	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Publications (number of publications)	–	–	3	3
2. Thematic reports on the challenges facing the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, including shared challenges such as vulnerabilities to external shocks, debt sustainability, access to sustainable energy and access to broadband services	–	–	3	3
Technical materials (number of materials)	–	–	2	2
3. Policy briefs for each country group to provide timely, concise and data-driven insights on topics related to the priorities of the three programmes of action	–	–	2	2
C. Substantive deliverables				
Databases and substantive digital materials: databases and interactive dashboards on relevant statistics, including on monitoring the implementation of the three programmes of action with related analytics and modelling results.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: communications materials to support global outreach campaigns for the three programmes of action and shared challenges and opportunities for the three groups of countries.				

Part IV International cooperation for development

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
External and media relations: press releases, op-eds, press conferences, media briefings and targeted interviews on issues related to the three groups of countries, including highlighting key milestones, events and progress on the three programmes of action and United Nations initiatives.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: the Office's website and web pages related to the three groups of countries, thematic priorities, events and research findings and reporting progress on the three programmes of action, including interactive graphics and videos.				